had to put the matter to Walker squarely. On Monday, December 17, I told him that I had an offer and that unless I got my professorship, I would take it.

On December 20, Walker told me that he had spoken to Dean Faulkner who had, in turn, agreed to recommend me for an assistant professorship and to have my salary gradually taken over by the school, thus moving me out from under Lemon.

I presume Walker had had an embarrassing session putting pressure on the dean, for he seemed annoyed with me and told me that he wouldn't advise me to try "these tactics" again as they "might backfire." I answered, quite coolly, that I had been quite prepared for a backfire this time and, indeed, had expected one.

So I ended the year of 1951 as an assistant professor of biochemistry at last after 2V2 years as an instructor. For the first time, I could call myself Professor Asimov.

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On December 28, I drove to New York by myself. The next day I saw Pohl and he gave me a check for $884.67, clearing up his entire indebtedness of the moment. On December 30, I met Harry Stubbs in midtown Manhattan and drove him back to Boston with me. It was now I who was giving rides to other people.

David ended the year weighing fifteen pounds and, as nearly as we could tell, making normal progress.

As for myself, for the second year in a row I had published two books: 4

3. The Stars, like Dust— (Doubleday)

4. Foundation (Gnome)

My writing earnings for 1951 were, however, a disappointment. I ended the year with a literary income of $3,625. It was only three quarters what I had made in 1950. It was better than my earnings in any other year by far, of course, but one is quickly spoiled.

My school income had gone up a bit, to $5,350, but that was not enough to make up for it. The total came to just under $9,000.